entities

Encode & decode HTML & XML entities with ease & speed.

Features

- 😇 Tried and true: `entities` is used by many popular libraries; eg. `htmlparser2`, the official AWS SDK and `commonmark` use it to process HTML entities.
- ⚡ Fast: `entities` is the fastest library for decoding HTML entities (as of April 2022); see performance.

- ❔ Configurable: Get an output tailored for your needs. You are fine with UTF8? That'll save you some bytes. Prefer to only have ASCII characters? We can do that as well!

How to…

…install `entities`

```
npm install entities
```

…use `entities`

```
const entities = require("entities");

// Encoding
entities.escapeUTF8("&#38; ü"); // "&amp;#38; ü"
entities.encodeXML("&#38; ü"); // "&amp;#38; &#xfc;"
entities.encodeHTML("&#38; ü"); // "&amp;amp;#38; &uuml;"
```


This is how `entities` compares to other libraries on a very basic benchmark (see `scripts/benchmark.ts`, for 10,000,000 iterations; **lower is better**):

Library	Version	decode perf	encode perf	escape perf
entities	3.0.1	1.418s	6.786s	2.196s
html-entities	2.3.2	2.530s	6.829s	2.415s
he	1.2.0	5.800s	24.237s	3.624s
parse-entities	3.0.0	9.660s	N/A	N/A


```
// Decoding
entities.decodeXML("asdf &amp; &#xFF; &#xFC; &apos;"); // "asdf & ÿ ü '"
entities.decodeHTML("asdf &amp; &yuml; &uuml; &apos;"); // "asdf & ÿ ü '"
```

Performance

This is how `entities` compares to other libraries on a very basic benchmark (see

FAQ

What methods should I actually use to encode my documents?

If your target supports UTF-8, the `escapeUTF8` method is going to be your best choice. Otherwise, use either `encodeHTML` or `encodeXML` based on whether you're dealing with an HTML or an XML document.

Why should I use `entities` instead of alternative modules?

As of April 2022, `entities` is a bit faster than other modules. Still, this is not a very differentiated space and other modules can catch up.

More importantly, you might already have `entities` in your dependency graph (as a dependency of eg. `cheerio`, or `htmlparser2`), and including it directly might not even

increase your bundle size. The same is true for other entity libraries, so have a look through your `node_modules` directory!

Does `entities` support tree shaking?

Yes! `entities` ships as both a CommonJS and a ES module. Note that for best results, you should not use the `encode` and `decode` functions, as they wrap around a number of other functions, all of which will remain in the

Acknowledgements

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- @mathiasbynens for his explanations about character encodings, and his library `he`, which was one of the inspirations for `entities`
- @inikulin for his work on optimized tries for decoding HTML entities for the `parse5` project
- @mdevils for taking on the challenge of producing a quick entity library with his `html-entities` library. `entities` would be quite a bit slower if there wasn't any competition. Right now `entities` is on top, but we'll see how long that lasts!

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`entities` for enterprise

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